"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 23

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

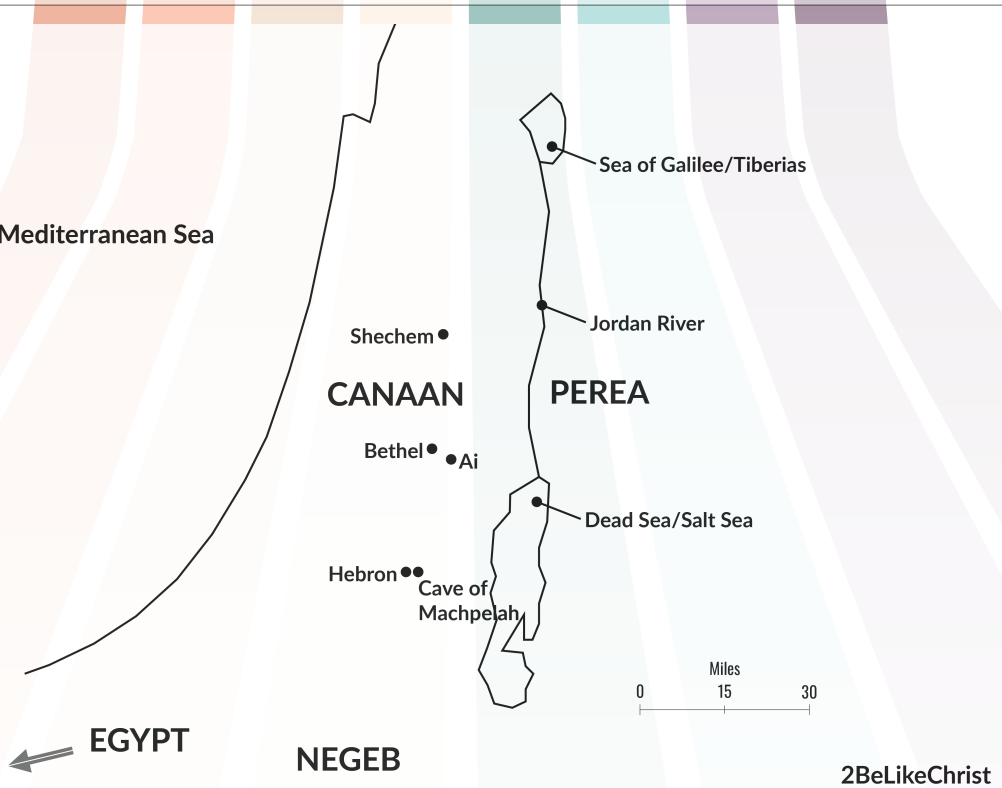
- Abram was born in approximately 1996 B.C. and died in 1821 B.C. at 175 years old (Gen 25:7).
- Isaac was born when Abraham was 100 years old, and Sarah was 90 years old (1896 B.C.). Sarah died at the age of 127 (approx. 1859 B.C.).

Characters:

- Abraham – A man from Ur of the Chaldeans who moved to Canaan at God's instruction. God promised to make his descendants a great nation and to give them the land of Canaan.
- Sarah – The wife of Abraham and mother of Isaac.
- Ephron – A Hittite man who sold the cave of Machpelah to Abraham.

Where:

- Sarah died at Kiriath-arba (Hebron). Sarah was buried in the cave of Machpelah which was "east of Mamre (that is, Hebron)" (23:17).



2BeLikeChrist

Outline:

- THE DEATH OF SARAH (23:1-2):
    + Sarah died at the age of 127.
    + At Sarah's death, Isaac would have been 37 and Abraham 137 years old.
    + Abraham mourned for her.
- ABRAHAM PURCHASES THE FIELD OF MACHPELAH (23:3-20):
    + Abraham visited the Hittites and asked to purchase a plot of land to bury Sarah.
    + The Hittites told him he could have any location he desired.
    + He asked if Ephron would be willing to sell him the field and cave of Machpelah.
    + Ephron told him he would give it to him for free, but Abraham insisted on paying a fair price.
    + The men agreed on a price of 400 shekels of silver.
    + Abraham buried Sarah in the cave.

Application:

- We often talk about the greatness of Abraham's faith, but rarely consider Sarah's faith.
- Sarah was willing to move hundreds of miles away from her home and family to obey God's instructions to Abraham to move to Canaan.
- She patiently waited for her promised son until she was 90 years old (Heb 11:11).
- She had her faults, but so did Abraham, and so do we.
- The Apostle Peter wrote that Christian women should consider themselves daughters of Sarah if they "do good and do not fear anything that is frightening" (1Peter 3:6).
- She is a role model for modern women of all ages.